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Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at my college, I am tasked with helping my peers navigate the digital world responsibly and professionally. My primary objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that serves as a resource for my batchmates and a demonstration of my own digital skills.

This project is organized into five distinct modules, covering essential areas such as:

- Creating visual awareness resources.
- Establishing a professional online presence on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub.
- Practicing collaborative coding and cloud-based tool management.
- Mastering professional email etiquette and social media conduct.
- Researching cybercrime prevention to ensure community safety.

By documenting these tasks in a centralized GitHub repository and this final report, I aim to showcase a foundational understanding of digital literacy that will support my academic and professional journey over the next four years.

Task 1: Infographic

To create this poster, I used Canva, a versatile and beginner-friendly graphic design tool that excels at turning complex information into visual content. I chose this platform because of the huge library of icons, diversity of designs and templates it had to offer to make it visually appealing and easily comprehendible. The grid-based layouts allowed me to organize three distinct topics – digital literacy definition, student tools and internet safety into a cohesive roadmap format. The design is structured as a vertical infographic. It uses a clear color-coding system (Red, Yellow and Blue) to separate the different sections making it easier to scan. The top section defines what it means to be "literate" online while the middle section lists practical tools like Notion, Python, Quizlet to be utilized in creating the digital content for better understanding and execution of tasks. The bottom section provides actionable safety tips such as using passkeys and the SIFT method for fact checking. The most interesting part of the process was researching the content and finding suitable imagery that would go along with it. It was quite difficult to edit my sentences to the bare minimum so that icons and textual content had enough space and there was an overall balance. Ultimately this project taught me that digital literacy isn't just a technical skill, it's a mindset that helps me stay curious, creative and secure in an ever-changing online world.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio

For this task, I chose to set up GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, as I feel these three best capture different sides of my growth as a developer. I've always viewed GitHub as my digital workbench; it is a version-control platform used for hosting and collaborating on code, but for me, it's a place to document my journey from writing simple scripts to building complex systems. LinkedIn serves a different purpose, acting as my bridge to the professional world and a place to learn from the career paths of people I admire. Finally, I chose Kaggle, a specialized community for data science and machine learning, because it offers a hands-on way to test my skills against real-world datasets and global competitions. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a "live diary" of my progress. Instead of just treating GitHub as a storage unit, I want to use it to document my daily coding habits. On LinkedIn, I plan to be more than a passive observer—I want to share my learning milestones and build a network that makes the industry feel less intimidating. By consistently updating these profiles, I hope to look back in four years and see a clear, visible journey from a beginner to a confident professional.

Task 3: Platforms

For this task, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. I practiced designing a variety of question types—including multiple-choice, short-answer, and checkboxes—to create an engaging and educational assessment tool for my batchmates. Beyond just building the form, I explored the backend integration by linking the form to a Google Sheet. This allowed me to practice real-time data collection and response management, ensuring that participant data is organized and ready for analysis immediately upon submission. Mastering these platforms significantly enhances my research and data management capabilities. Furthermore, reinforcing my understanding of digital literacy—such as identifying phishing and securing personal accounts—is essential for protecting my academic work and maintaining a secure digital identity throughout my university career.

Task 4: Email Etiquette

I recently came across a write up where I read about a final year graduating student who lost a super dream offer from a company due to an unjustifiable mistake he had committed years ago on a digital platform. He was graduating college and had landed his dream role, but during a final background check, the company found an old, offensive joke he'd shared on Twitter years ago. Even though he'd totally forgotten about it and wasn't that person anymore, the company didn't care. They pulled the offer immediately, saying his "online values" didn't align with theirs. It showed me that the internet has a terrifyingly long memory. What he should have done, and what I do now is a "digital deep clean" every few months. I went back and deleted anything from my younger years that didn't represent who I am today.

Now, I follow a simple rule: if I wouldn't want it printed on the front page of a newspaper, I don't post it. It's better to be a little boring online than to let a five-second decision ruin a four-year degree.

Task 5: Cybercrime

Honestly, what caught me off guard most while digging into this was how much cybercrime in India has shifted from "technical hacking" to "psychological mind games." I always thought I was too tech-savvy to fall for a scam, but seeing how cleverly fraudsters exploit the high-pressure environment of college admissions and entrance exams was a reality check. They don’t just steal data; they weaponize our stress.

Because of this, the one habit I’m personally changing is saving my payment details on food delivery and shopping apps. It’s incredibly convenient to have my card "remembered," but I’ve realized that my financial security shouldn't be traded for three seconds of convenience. From now on, I’m manually entering my UPI ID or card info every single time—it’s a small friction that acts as a big safety net.

Conclusion

Completing this project has been a transformative experience in defining my role as a Student Digital Ambassador. Through the five specialized tasks, I have moved beyond being a passive user of technology to becoming an active, professional, and secure digital citizen. I now possess the foundational skills to manage a professional online presence on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub, which will be essential for my academic and professional career over the next four years.

Furthermore, I have gained a deep appreciation for the nuances of professional communication and the critical importance of cybersecurity awareness in the Indian context. This portfolio, housed in my GitHub repository, serves as a permanent testament to my digital literacy and my commitment to helping my peers navigate the digital world safely and responsibly.

References links

canva.com

github.com, linkedin.com, kaggle.com

hackerrank.com,